Chapter Four

Technical Writing

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Technical Communication

- **Technical Communication** is a means to document or convey scientific, engineering, or other technical information.
- **Focuses** on technical or specialized topics, **communicates** specifically by using technology or provides instructions **on how to do something.**
- Put information captured ***into*** paper documents, web pages, digitally stored text, audio, video, and other media types.

Technical Communication

- It is a professional task performed by **specialized employees** or **consultants**. ***e.g***. Professional writer may work with a company to produce a user manual.
- Some companies give responsibility to other technical professionals—*such as* **programmers**, **engineers**, and **scientists**.

It is important to most professions, as **a way to contain** and **organize information** and **maintain accuracy**.

The Importance of Technical Writing

- In today's workplace writing is a '**Threshold Skill**' for **hiring** and **promotion** among salaried.

- **Business Technical Communication is not an extra or an occasional effort**.

- It is a **major component** of the **work environment**.

The Importance of Technical Writing

Through technical correspondence, ***employees can***:

- Maintain good customer/client relations (***Follow-up letters***).
- Ensure that work is accomplished on time (***Directive memos or E-mail***).
- Provide documentation that work, projects, or processes has been completed (***Progress Reports***).
- Generate income (***Sales letters, Brochures,*** *and* ***Fliers***).

The Importance of Technical Writing

Through technical correspondence, ***employees can***:

- Keep devices, Equipments, or machinery working (***User Manuals***)
- Ensure that correct equipment is purchased (***Technical Descriptions***).
- Participate effectively in teleconferences or videoconferences activities (***Oral Communication***).
- Inform the world about a company's products and services (***Internet Web Sites*** *and* ***Blogs***).
- Get a job, perform interview (***Resumes***).
- Define terminology (***Online Help Screens***).

The Importance of Technical Writing

Technical Communication is a significant factor in your work experience for several reasons. The importance

- Measure of the success and growth
- Valuable repository of information
- Tangible product of the work
- Develop desirable qualities
- Reveals gaps in thinking
- Link within and outside
- Life line of business

Technical Writing Definition

The Society for Technical Communication defines **Technical Communication** as **any form of communication that exhibits one or more of the following characteristics:**

1. **Communicating about technical or specialized topics**, *such as* computer applications, medical procedures, or environmental regulations;
2. **Communicating through technology**, *such as* web pages, help files, or social media sites; or
3. **Providing instructions about how to do something**, regardless of the task's technical nature".

Technical Writing Definition

- **Technical writing** is **any written form** of writing or drafting technical communication **used** in a **variety** of technical and occupational **fields**, ***such as*** **computer hardware and software, engineering, chemistry, aeronautics, robotics, finance, biotechnology**... etc.

- It is a type of writing where **the author** is **producing specific documents** about a **particular subject** that requires **direction**, **instruction**, or **explanation**.

Technical Writing Definition

- This style of writing has a **very different purpose** and **different characteristics** than other writing styles ***such as*** **creative writing, academic writing or business writing.**

Uses for Technical Writing

- It is straightforward, easy to understand explanations and/or instructions dealing with a particular subject.

- It is an efficient and clear way of explaining something and how it works.

Technical Writing Definition

The subject of technical writing can either be:

- Tangible
- Abstract

Some examples

- Instruction manuals
- Policy manuals
- Process manuals
- User manuals
- Reports of analysis
- Instructions for assembling a product.

- A summarization of a long report that highlights and shortens the most important elements.

Technical Writing Definition

Regardless of the type of document which is written, technical writing requires the writer to follow the properties of :

- **knowing their audience,**
- **writing in a clear, non-personal style** *and*
- **doing extensive research on the topic.**

Tips for Good Technical Writing

- A technical writer is, responsible for creating technical documents.

- Technical writers are generally employed by companies to create documents and materials for use by

  - employees,
  - consumers or
  - other businesses.

Tips for Good Technical Writing

Tips to help you improve your technical writing skills.

Know your audience.

Use an impersonal style.

The writing should be straightforward

Recognize *the Content.*

Know how to research.

Be methodical in description and provide enough detail to make your points.

Outline, then Execute.

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Tips for Good Technical Writing

Tips to help you improve your technical writing skills.

Define Your Project and Stick to It.

Simplify Your Language.

Establish a Clear Structure.

Use Your Layout.

Incorporate Useful Visuals.

Establish an Appropriate Voice.

Avoid Time-Sensitive Claims.

Cite Your Sources.

Revise. Revise. Revise.

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Tips for Good Technical Writing

A good technical writer can

- make a difficult task easy

and

- can quickly explain a complex piece of information.

Steps of Technical Writing

1. Determine Purpose and Audience

2. Collect Information

3. Organize and Outline Information

- Chronological
- Parts of an Object
- Simple *to* Complex
- Specific *to* General
- General *to* Specific

Steps of Technical Writing

4. Write The First Draft

5. Revise and Edit

- Technical communication is written and oral communication for and about business and industry.
- It focuses on products and services—how to manufacture them, market them, manage them, deliver them, and use them.
- It is composed primarily in the work environment for supervisors, colleagues, subordinates, vendors, and customers.

Steps of Technical Writing

As either a professional technical communicator, an employee at a company, or a consumer, you can expect to write the following types of correspondence for the following reasons (and many more).

- CIS employee
- A trust officer in a bank
- A customer
- A technical communicator
- The manager of medical records reporting department
- A webmaster
- An entrepreneur
- Graduated from college

Techniques of Technical Writing

- Good technical writing is **concise**, **focused**, **easy to understand**, **free of errors**, and is **audience-based**.
- Technical documents are used in real-world situations, it should always be explicitly clear.
- Technical writing requires a writer to extensively examine their audience.

Techniques of Technical Writing

- Technical writing must be accurate.
- The goal is to convey the message in an accurate and ethical manner.
- Document design and layout are also very important components of technical writing.
- Images, diagrams, and videos are also commonly employed to convey complex information

Tools of Technical Writing

Desktop Publishing Tools or Word Processors.

Help Authoring Tools

Image Editing Software.

Collaborative Software Programs.

Web Development Tools.

Graphing Software.

Screen Capture Tools

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Technical Documents

Technical writing covers many kinds and writing styles depending on the information and audience.

Instructions and Procedures

Emails, Letters, and Memoranda

Proposals

Specifications

Press Releases

Descriptions

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Technical Documents

Technical writing covers many kinds and writing styles depending on the information and audience.

Résumés and Job Applications

Technical Reports

White Papers

Case Study

Websites

Datasheets

API Guides

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How to write a formal letter

✍ Examples of formal letters ✍

- Letters of complaint;
- Travel reservations;
- Job applications - you may need to enclose your curriculum vitae;
- Questioning a decision;
- Enquiries about work experience;
- Resignation letter;
- Appointment letter;

How to write a formal letter

- Sick Leave Application;
- Leave Application for Marriage;
- Leave application for maternity;
- Business letter.

Addresses and Date

Beginning the letter

Tone and Purpose

Ending the letter

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Formal Letter Format

Name of the Sender
Address
Date
To
Name of the Recipient
Designation
Company Name
Address

Saluttation (Dear Sir,/Madam)
Subject:
Body of the Letter

[Write 2 -3 paragraphs including the reason behind the letter. Make sure to keep the letter concise without dragging too much]

Thank you for your consideration. Waiting for your response.

Yours Sincerely,
Name
Signature

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